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- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kpuRc4xfsPE
- LIS House minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/H

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[00:15:50] House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. The House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:16:06] The members will rise and be laid in prayer by Reverend Ralph S. Hodge, Pastor, Second Baptist Church, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Let us pray. Most high God, we humble ourselves before you today to give you glory and honor.

[00:16:26] We thank you for all that you have already done for us. We thank you for the beauty of creation. We thank you, Lord, for your glorious acts. We thank you, Lord, for all that you have already done. Now, Lord, give us the strength and courage to serve with love, kindness, gentleness, and compassion.

[00:16:45] Lord, lead these public officials to serve with a desire to correct injustices and promote fairness. Guide this body to be bold and courageous to fund more affordable housing, provide better access to health care, and open the doors of educational opportunities.

[00:17:01] Help them to be good stewards of the people's resources and help them resist serving for selfish gain and vain ambition. Lord, give us ears that hear the voices that are often ignored and forgotten.

Lord, give them the voice to speak up for the voiceless. Lord, give them the power to give strength to the weak.

[00:17:19] Lord, help them govern in a way that fosters community and not division. Cause them to cast off any weight that easily entangles and straighten any crooked place within. Help them govern in a way that respects rights and freedoms. Let them govern in a way that protects and supports those who have limited resources.

[00:17:37] Empty them of all pride and arrogance. Remove all malice and strife. Cleanse them from iniquity and wickedness, and fill them with humility, mercy, love, and wisdom. Lord, let love reign. Let love guide. Let love be at the center of their governance. In your name we pray.

[00:17:53] Amen. Amen. The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:18:39] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I've examined and approved the journal House of Delegates for February 2, 2026. Motions of resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order. Does the clerk have any announcements or communications?

[00:18:55] No announcements or communications. Therefore, pursuant to House Rule 40, Speaker, request that you use your request to speak button for your agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion.

[00:19:11] The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move that House Bill 786 on page 21 be re-referred to the Committee on Education. Delegate moves that House Bill 786 on page 21 be re-referred to the Committee on Education.

[00:19:27] All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is re-referred to the Committee on Education. The Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Smith. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. The Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, today I would like to introduce Pastor Ralph Stephen Hodge.

[00:19:44] Please stand. Pastor Hodge was born in Washington, D.C. and raised in Fort Washington, Maryland. He is a 1992 graduate of Howard University with a degree in chemistry. In 1995, he received his Master's of Divinity from Virginia Union University.

[00:20:02] For over 30 years, Pastor Hodge has called Richmond his home. He first served the St. Paul's Baptist Church as the chief ministry officer before becoming the senior pastor for Second Baptist Church in South Richmond, right in my neighborhood. Pastor Hodge has served the Second Baptist Church for over 23 years.

[00:20:21] He has dedicated the church, he has directed the church in many community-wide initiatives. He led the church to create one of the largest urban farms in the city and a thriving farmer's market that provides opportunities for minority farmers to sell their produce.

[00:20:37] with a guarantee that all produce is purchased by the end of each market day. This Broadrock Farmers Market also allows local Girl Scouts to earn merit badges through the exercise program that is held during market days, and I encourage you all to come visit in warmer weather when it's available.

[00:20:54] The church is also recognized during COVID-19 crisis by the General Assembly in the United States Senate as the first community hub to provide space for COVID testing and vaccinations. Pastor Hodge is also the former co-president and current vice president of Richmonders Involved to Strengthen Communities, aka RISC, the social justice organization that has successfully advocated for millions of dollars in health care and affordable housing funding.

[00:21:22] RISC is also responsible for the creation of health care jobs pipeline at VCU Hospital. In addition to Pastor Hodge's other nonprofit boards and affiliations, he has taught thousands of elementary school students as a math interventionist in Henrico County since 1997.

[00:21:40] That alone makes him my hero. He is married to the former Cassandra Elder of Richmond, Virginia, and together they have four adult sons, two daughters in love, and two grand puppies. It will be my pleasure and I hope that the house will give him a nice warm house welcome today.

[00:22:00] Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Askew. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for request, two motions and an introduction.

[00:22:20] Really? The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I request to take up out of order H.R. 59, which is not on today's calendar. Clerk will report a resolution. House resolution number 59, celebrating the life of Jonathan Lane White.

[00:22:37] Delegate for Virginia Beach, delegate to ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the adoption of H.R. 59, and I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns the honor and memory of Jonathan Lane White. I'd like to speak to that motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, Coach White was more than a coach.

[00:22:55] He was a mentor, a teacher, and a steady presence for countless young people in Virginia Beach, including the student athletes he led at Bayside High School. On the field, in the classroom, he pushed his players to be excellent students, leaders, and teammates. And he never lost sight of the bigger goal, shipping young men and women who would succeed long after the final whistle.

[00:23:13] As a proud brother of Alpha Phi Alpha Fraternity Incorporated and an alum of Hampton University, Coach White lived out the fraternity's commitment to scholarship, leadership, and service every day. quietly pouring it to his community and lifting up the next generation. He embodied the ideas of manly deeds, scholarship, and love for all mankind and the way he showed up for his players, his colleagues, his cities, and his line brothers.

[00:23:34] Coach White's legacy will live on in the lives of the young people he believed in, the families he supported, and the coaches and educators he inspired to keep doing the work. On behalf of the people of the 95th District and 97th District, I extend our deepest condolences to his family, his Alpha Alpha brothers, the Bayside High School community, and all who mourn him today.

[00:23:53] Mr. Speaker, I respectfully move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns the honor and memory of Jonathan White. The delegate from Virginia Beach, I would ask you to move the adoption of House Resolution 59 and that when the House adjourns today, it adjourns the honor and memory of Jonathan Lane White. All those in favor shall please rise.

[00:24:12] The motion is agreed to. The delegate from Virginia Beach, I would ask you. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise again for an introduction. Joining us today are the brothers from the Virginia Association of

Chapters of Al-Five Fraternity Incorporated, also known as VACA-PATH.

[00:24:30] Can they please stand? As a brother of Alpha Alpha and someone who has the honor of serving the people of Hampton Roads and the Commonwealth, we have the pleasure to welcome the brothers here in the chamber today. Alpha Alpha Returning Incorporated has been shaping leaders and changing lives for more than a century, and that impact is not abstract to Virginia.

[00:24:48] It is personal and present. From the first chapter that was founded on the campus of Cornell University in 1906, which if you do the mass a few years before 1911, but we won't go there, to the brothers who now serve as pastors, educators, and entrepreneurs and public servants, Alpha men have helped build the very communities we represent.

[00:25:06] Our charge has always been the same, to turn our education and our experience into service and to expand opportunity for the next generation. Mr. Speaker, that same alpha spirit is reflected in your leadership and in the service of our fellow alpha man, Delegate Fagans. Here in our Commonwealth, you see that commitment in real time.

[00:25:22] You found alpha men mentoring young people in our neighborhoods, organizing around voting rights and civic engagement, advocating for equity in education, housing and transportation, and leading institutions like Virginia State University, Virginia Union University, Hampton University, and Old Dominion University.

[00:25:38] That is spirit of manly deeds, scholarship, and love for all mankind lived out every day. Not just in words, but in tangible work that moves Virginia forward. As we conduct the people's business in the chamber, office presence here today is a reminder of why we're here, to listen to our communities, to lead with integrity, and to lead this commonwealth better than we found it.

[00:25:56] Their annual visit to the Capitol underscores their partnership between citizen leadership and legislative leadership between the brothers doing the work on the ground and those of us entrusted to write the laws. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, please join me in extending a warm house welcome to Vacopath. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol Day. Y'all look so good. Y'all must good in that black and gold. Anyway, I couldn't help myself. The delegate from Loudoun County,

[00:26:32] Delegate Reed. Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, joining us today in the gallery is the Dulles Area Association of Realtors, so I'd like to ask them to stand. The Dulles Area Association of Realtors, or DAR, has a long and distinguished history.

[00:26:51] Although the name has changed during its 64 years of existence, their community leadership accomplishments have consistently been outstanding. They were often recognized regionally as the leading advocates for property rights and real estate issues. Their mission is to support their members, the real estate industry, and the communities they serve with the highest standards of ethics, professionalism, and inclusion.

[00:27:14] I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to join me and Delegate Reeser, who also represents part of the Dulles area, and give them a warm house welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Montgomery County, Delegate Franklin.

[00:27:38] Mr. Speaker, I rise for an introduction. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, today we are delighted to welcome undergraduate students from Virginia Tech who have joined

us in the gallery today as part of Hokie Day. If they could rise. This annual tradition brings students from all across the Commonwealth to the General Assembly to engage directly with legislators, share their experience at Virginia Tech, and learn about the important work they do on behalf of Virginians.

[00:28:05] Throughout the day, these students have been meeting with members, visiting offices, and gaining a firsthand look at the legislative process. Their presence here today reflects their strong commitment to civic engagement and public service, and we are pleased to have them with us. I ask that the House join me in giving a warm house welcome to our Hokie guests.

[00:28:22] Welcome, welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for the purpose of two introductions.

[00:28:41] The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Today in the gallery, we have joined by family members of people with developmental disabilities, in addition to professionals in the field of DD supports and advocacy from across Hampton Roads.

[00:28:57] I ask that they please stand to be recognized. Mr. Speaker, they are here as part of the Arc of Virginia's Regional Developmental Disabilities Advocacy Day, where we were joined by our voices, self-advocates supported by Hope House Foundation to engage with members of members during the session on issues critical to Virginians with developmental disabilities, including increased rates for essential Medicaid waiver services, funding for rental assistance,

[00:29:30] expanded employment supports and opportunities and ensuring that disability rights are preserved and protected. Please join me as we extend to them a warm house welcome. For the second introduction Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker I rise today and I am pleased to recognize the members of Envision

[00:30:05] lead grow incorporated who are joined uh in the gallery today uh as their day on the hill i ask that they will please stand and be recognized mr speaker little girls with dreams become women with vision that is the mantra for this organization that visits us today and while here these young leaders are learning about the legislative process and meeting with legislators from their respective districts, an experience that reflects their commitment to civic engagement, leadership, and public service.

[00:30:42] Envision League Grow is celebrating its 10th anniversary, making a decade of transformative work empowering girls and women through entrepreneurship, leadership, development, and economic opportunity. Founded in 2016 by Dr. Angela Reddix, the organization was built on the belief that every girl deserves the opportunity to dream boldly, lead confidently, and shape her own future.

[00:31:11] What began as a program serving just over 400 girls in seven high-poverty cities has grown into a nationally recognized initiative that has empowered over 4,000 girls across 48 states.

[00:31:26] Today, Mr. Speaker, Envision Lead Grow is proudly rooted in Portsmouth, operating from the Mustard Seed Place a 33,000 square foot empowerment hub dedicated to innovation, collaboration, and community impact. Mr. Speaker, through research based programming, residential summer immersion camps, family-centered entrepreneurship initiatives, and youth-led ventures like Envision Lead Grow, Sweet Boutique, Envision Lead Grow continues to cultivate confident, capable leaders who strengthen their communities.

[00:32:03] Mr. Speaker, it is fitting that we commend Envision Lead Grow for 10 years of distinguished service, visionary leadership, and lasting impact across the Commonwealth. I ask that the members please join me as we extend to them a warm House welcome.

[00:32:32] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate for Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, in House Bill 1377, having voted on the prevailing side, by which we engrossed House Bill 1377, on page 13, I move that we now reconsider that vote.

[00:32:56] For what purpose? On the prevailing side, by which we engrossed House Bill 1377, I move that we reconsider that vote and get this bill back in amendable form. Okay. A delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon, having voted on the prevailing side by which we passed HB 1377, found on page 13, excited to be voted on again so they could go back to an amendable form, I guess, second read.

[00:33:18] All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Mr. Speaker? Yes. I move that House Bill 1377 go by for the day. Without objection, HB 1377 is by for the day. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction.

[00:33:37] Delegate has the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, in the gallery of today, we have representatives from several of Virginia's renewable energy trade associations, including Advanced Energy United, Chesapeake Solar and Storage Association, Coalition for Community Solar Access, Solar Energy Industries Association, and the Virginia Distributed Solar Alliance. I ask them to please rise at this time. I feel like there should be a few more, considering how many names I just read out.

[00:34:04] Some of them got two names. Mr. Speaker, Virginia's solar market is home to over 200 companies that are leading the charge to decarbonize our electric grid, strengthen domestic supply chains, and invest in local workers to deliver reliable, affordable power for communities across the Commonwealth.

[00:34:22] And with that, I request that the members please join me in extending them a warm House welcome. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today.

[00:34:38] Pursuant to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are away on pressing personal business. On a granted lead from today's session, Delegates Keyes, Gamara, and Knight. Clerk will announce the next order of business. Second portion of the morning, our announcement of member requests to move legislation from the uncontested calendar to the regular calendar.

[00:34:55] There are nine, seven of them in that first category, House Bill's third reading uncontested, delegates, page four, Delegate Maytas, House Bill 185. On page seven, Delegate Pope Adams, House Bill 326.

[00:35:13] On page 8, Delegate Doherty's House Bill 363. Page 9, Delegate McAuliffe's House Bill 510 and Delegate Thornton's House Bill 528. All of those out of the block over to the regular calendar at the request of Delegate Tram.

[00:35:32] And then also on page 12, Delegate Price's House Bill 78 and Delegate Anthony's House Bill 1244. Both of those on page 12 out of the block over to the regular calendar at the request of Delegate Wyatt.

[00:35:48] And then skipping forward in the calendar to the second reading uncontested. Second reading on the contested block, page 34, Delegate Simons, House Bill 446. And page 35, Delegate Hopes, House Bill 481. Those out of the second uncontested block over to the regular calendar request of Delegate Wyatt.

[00:36:06] The third portion of the morning, I reserve an announcement of member requests. Legislation is going to buy for the day, and if such, a subsequent motion by the Majority Leader. There are a couple, two, I believe. Page three, third reading uncontested.

[00:36:23] Delegate Williams, House Bill 148, buy for the day. And then forwarding to second regular, page 45. Page 45, if you're following along that way. Delegate Hayes is House Bill 649, buy for the day at the request of Delegate Tran.

[00:36:45] Mr. Speaker, I move that the legislation, as announced by the clerk, go by for the day.

[00:37:25] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that the legislation, as announced by the clerk, go by for the day. As many faith, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk will announce the next order. And, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the fourth and final portion of the morning hour is heard for member requests for points of person privilege. Kindly use your request to speak buttons.

[00:37:41] Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I request that we go back to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. Delicate, that's the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. This morning we are joined by the Fund Our Schools Coalition, if they could please rise. The Fund Our Schools Coalition is a powerful and united force of parents, students, teachers, and community organizations across Virginia that are working tirelessly to ensure that our schools are fully and fairly funded.

[00:38:11] In addition, the coalition emphasizes the importance of the community involvement in schools, advocating for models that integrate families and local communities into the educational process. Everyday people fighting for schools and students, I hope the House can join me in giving them a warm House welcome.

[00:38:36] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. The Delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move that we go back to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to ask the members of the Virginia Coalition of Latino Organizations, Vaca Lau, to please rise.

[00:38:56] Mr. Speaker, since 2002, the Virginia Coalition of Latino Organizations, Vaca Lau, has stood at the forefront of advocacy for Latino families across the Commonwealth. This powerful alliance of community organizations has worked diligently to defend the rights, dignity, and well-being of Latino and immigrant communities across Virginia.

[00:39:18] Bacalao's mission is rooted in empowerment, striving to ensure equitable treatment, expand opportunities, and secure fair representation so that every Latino in Virginia can have their voice heard. For over two decades, they have guided and mentored the next generation of Latino leaders, helping them engage in the political process through their Advocacy Day.

[00:39:34] Today, they come before this body to advocate for investment in community health and education, expansion of access to affordable housing, and the defense of all Virginians' constitutional

rights. Please join me in recognizing their profound impact on building a stronger, more just future for all Latino and new American youth, and let's give them a warm house welcome.

[00:40:02] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Welcome. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege.

[00:40:18] The delegate has the floor. The Civil Rights Movement was a beautiful symphony of different faiths and backgrounds joined in a common cause. Today, as we celebrate Black History Month, I'd like to tell the story of an unlikely figure in that struggle, Rabbi Abraham Joshua Heschel. A refugee from Nazi-occupied Europe, Rabbi Heschel arrived in America with a deep understanding of what happens when hate is allowed to flourish. He saw in the struggle of black Americans not just a political movement, but a theological necessity. He famously said, in a free society, some are guilty,

[00:40:55] but all are responsible. In the iconic image we all have etched into our memories of the Edmund Pettus Bridge on March 7th, 1965, there in the front row stood Rabbi Heschel, his white beard flowing, Torah in hand, walking shoulder to shoulder with Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. and John Lewis. When asked after about how the march to Montgomery felt, he said, I felt my legs were praying. Heschel taught us that silence is the greatest ally of injustice. He believed that the

[00:41:29] prophets of the Bible weren't just historical figures, but examples of how we must live today with moral amazement at the world and divine impatience for justice. As we honor the giants of black history this month, let us also remember the bridge builders like Rabbi Heschel. He reminds us that our liberation is bound together. He showed us that when we march for the dignity of our neighbor, we aren't just walking down a street. We are walking toward a more sacred world.

[00:42:03] May we all find the courage to let our legs pray for justice today. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett.

[00:42:23] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise on a point of personal privilege. Delegate, on the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'm going to speak today in memory of Charlie Kirk and anyone else who's given their life standing for truth. I pray that the creator, Mr. Speaker, who made you and me in his image gives me the strength to do justice to their legacy.

[00:42:43] Mr. Speaker, banning leaf blowers is stupid, but it's the foreseeable conclusion of what happens when you put Karen in charge. I rise today not to speak to that which is stupid, Mr. Speaker, but to that which is evil. If I was speaking to which was stupid, we'd be here a while, but which is evil is House Bill 333.

[00:43:06] You don't believe me? Multiply it by two. Coincidence? I think not. What does the bill do, Mr. Speaker? It mandates an opinion. It tells our teachers that they have to teach certain things. It takes lies, Mr. Speaker, and makes them law. And then it tests our children on their ability to recite these lies.

[00:43:26] It tells us what we're not allowed to say, and it tells us what we must say. This has been done before, Mr. Speaker. It's been done in Nazi Germany. It's been done in Maoist China. It's been done in the former Soviet Union, where they had commissars who would travel around and make sure that what you said comported with what the party allowed you to say.

[00:43:45] And I will tell you, Mr. Speaker, that historically, if you got on the wrong side of the commissar, you got on the wrong side of the dirt. As it relates to January 6th, teachers must say it was a violent

insurrection. It was started by Donald Trump, and it was done to overturn democracy.

[00:44:01] They can't say these things were demonstrably true. There were literally, demonstrably, at least 274 federal agents in the crowd who did nothing to stop it. They can't say that the FBI director lied about it when he was asked about it, and it was later revealed that he was lying.

[00:44:17] They can't say that Donald Trump literally called on protesters to peacefully and patriotically make their voices heard. They can't say that. They must say that it was a violent mob that attacked the Capitol. They can't say that the Democratic D.C. mayor refused an offer of 10,000 National Guardsmen to help keep peace.

[00:44:34] Can't say that. We live in a world where we can't say, son, I was there when you were born. You're a boy. But we must say, who am I to say whether you're a boy or a girl? We can't say tax increase. We must say revenue enhancement. We can't say that people in this country illegally have literally taken the lives of thousands of Americans in DUI accidents alone.

[00:44:56] We must say that driver privilege cards help marginalized minorities. We can't say that Lake and Riley was murdered on the Internet. We have to say that she was unalived. And we can't say that the person who unalived her was an illegal immigrant. We must say that her murderer was a migrant in search of a better life.

[00:45:15] We can't say that activity on the sun is a thousand times more impactful than all the anthropogenic climate change in the history of humankind. we must say that the anthropogenic climate change will melt the ice caps in the near future and scare the hell out of our kids we can't tell our kids that not that they and not long dead colonizers are the most important arbiters and whether they're happy or sad and successful or failures we must say that our kids are either victims or beneficiaries of some systemic long

[00:45:49] dead racist legacy last year mr speaker i heard someone say you keep dr king's name out of your mouth. Apparently, we live in a world where I can't say I have a dream that my children will live in a society where they'll not be judged by the color of their skin, but by the content of their character.

[00:46:08] Mr. Speaker, you may come for my leaf blower, you may come for my 11-round magazine, you may come for my modern sporting rifle, you can come for my hair dye and my shampoo. You can come for my duly elected member of Congress, you can come and take my life. Better people than me have died for worse things than the truth.

[00:46:27] Come and take it. What you can't take is this. You can't take my kids. And regardless of whether this bill passes or not, you can't take the truth. That belongs to us. Thank you. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan.

[00:46:53] Mr. Speaker, I request we go back to the first morning hour. For what purpose, Delegate? For an introduction. The delegate has the floor. I might have another motion later in the week. Mr. Speaker, joining us in the gallery today are representatives of the Northern Virginia Chamber, if I could ask them to rise.

[00:47:15] There they are. Mr. Speaker, NVC's delegation this year includes leaders from companies such as William A. Hazel, Clark Construction, Deloitte, Anthem Blue Cross Blue Shield, BF Sol Hospitality,

Comstock, Cooley, Dev Technology Group, Kaiser Permanente, Cox Communications, Verizon, UVA Health, Wells Fargo, and many, many more.

[00:47:36] Mr. Speaker, NVC's NOVA roadmap calls for the creation of a Northern Virginia economy that competes by design, not by default. And they wanted me, Mr. Speaker, to add that NVC applauds the General Assembly for our actions this session to increase housing stock across the Commonwealth, which is a critical business need. So why don't we return that applause and give them a warm House welcome.

[00:48:03] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Thank you for being here. The Kirk will call the calendar. Calendar for today, Tuesday, February 3rd, 2026 for the Virginia House of Delegates, 120 pieces, give or take, spread across pages 1 through 47 of today's calendar, first category. House bills on third reading uncontested calendar, final passage in the uncontested calendar block, about two dozen bills house bill 544 as well as house bill 52 65 73 128 133 house bill 148 is by for the day out

[00:48:39] of the block continuing page 4 house bill 163 is in the block house bill 185 on page 4 is out of the block over to the regular calendar continuing with the block house bills 198 223 252 276 292 306 307 top of page 7 house bill 326 out of the block over to the regular calendar continuing with the the block, House Bill 332, 344, top of page 8, the printed calendar, House Bill 363, out of the block to the regular calendar, House Bill 401, House Bill 445, 488 are in the block.

[00:49:11] On page 9, House Bill 510, out of the block, over to the regular calendar, continuing with the block, House Bill 512, page 10, House Bill 528 is out of the block, over to the regular calendar, continuing with the block, therefore, House Bill 555, 671, 716, 960, 1084, over on page 12. Rounding out the block, House Bills on third reading, uncontested, final passage, House Bill 59, House Bill 78, and House Bill 1244 on pages 12 are out of the block over to the regular calendar. That's the block before you now. It's just getting started, y'all.

[00:49:47] Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 98, no zero. Ayes, 98, no zero. The bills passed. Next category, House Bills on third reading or final passage, regular calendar.

[00:50:11] Four dozen-ish bills here beginning top of page 13. House Bill 1377 is not before you. It's a bye for the day. So therefore, the first bill, third reading, regular, final passage is House Bill 1 relating to minimum wage.

[00:50:27] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 64, nos 34.

[00:50:43] Ayes 64, nos 34. The bill passes. Continuing over on page 14, now before you is House Bill 134 relating to Virginia Conservation Easement Act, definitions, federally recognized tribes.

[00:51:02] Shall the bill pass?

[00:51:12] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 5. Ayes 93, noes 5, the bill passed. House Bill 139 relating to school board policies, unpaid educationally for certain employee association officers, purchase of service credit.

[00:51:30] Shall the bill pass?

[00:51:40] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 35. Ayes 62, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 182 relates to high school graduation requirements, history and social study credits, certain substitutions permitted. Shall the bill pass?

[00:51:59] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 34. Ayes 63, noes 34. The bill passes. Top of page 15. House Bill 183 now before you relates to first-time homebuyer savings plan, townhouses, principal limits.

[00:52:18] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 96, nose 2. Ayes 96, nose 2. The bill passes.

[00:52:35] House Bill 201 relating to school board policies, parental notification, safe storage of prescription drugs and firearms in the household. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:52:53] Ayes 62, nose 35. Ayes 62, nose 35. The bill passes. House Bill 221 relates to requirements for appeals bond, indigent parties, appeal of unlawful detainer. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:53:17] Ayes, 62, noes, 35. Ayes, 62, noes, 35. The bill passes. Over on page 16, House Bill 244, now before you, relates to robbery. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:53:39] Ayes, 64, noes, 34. Ayes, 64, noes, 34. The bill passes. House Bill 245 relates to a jurisdiction of district courts in felony cases, specialty dockets, Behavioral Health Docket Act. Shall the bill pass?

[00:53:58] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 76, noes 19. Ayes 76, noes 19. The bill passes. House Bill 256 relates to comprehensive plan, environmental justice strategy.

[00:54:15] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 258 relates to early childhood care and education terminology.

[00:54:35] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 92, ayes 93, noes 5.

[00:54:51] Ayes 93, noes 5. The bill passes. House Bill 268 relates to fines and costs, period of limitation on collection, deferred payment agreement. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:55:11] Ayes 91, noes 7. Ayes 91, noes 7. The bill passes. House Bill 273 relates to law enforcement officers' duty to render aid upon danger to life or limb, civil immunity. Shall the bill pass?

[00:55:31] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 64, noes. 34. Ayes. 64, noes. 34. The bill passed. Continuing third reading regular over on page 18, if you're following that way. House Bill 291 relates to the Department of Wildlife Resources, Fishing, Tackle, Recycling and Disposal, Educational webpage report.

[00:55:54] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes. 74, noes. 24. Ayes.

[00:56:09] 74, noes. 24. The bill passes. House Bill 331 relates to payment of costs when proceedings deferred. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:56:27] Ayes 65, nos 32. Ayes 65, nos 32. The bill passes. House Bill 333, legislation relates to public schools, programs, and courses of instruction, instruction on January 6th insurrection, requirements, and limitations.

[00:56:44] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, my family knows something of fascism. My grandmother survived the Holocaust. She survived the Soviet invasion of her homeland, both of which killed many of her family members.

[00:57:01] And she'd tell you that the beginning of dictatorship starts when we tell lies about commonly accepted truths. But nonetheless, let's be clear about what this bill says. If the delegate from Buckingham or anybody else wants to lie to their kids about what happened on January 6th, it is not prohibited by this bill.

[00:57:22] If he wants to tell them that Trump was responsible for the January 6th insurrection, he can. And that's the truth, but it's not specifically in the bill, as he attested. So let's be clear about what this bill does. It ensures that our public schools teach the truth if school boards choose to teach about January 6th.

[00:57:44] And it honors the Virginia National Guardsmen and state police who stood the breach that day, many of whom came and were honored before us, and many of whom were injured, some suffering long-term injuries for their service. I hope it is the will of the body to pass the bill.

[00:58:03] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 35.

[00:58:19] Ayes 63, noes 35. The bill passes. Top of page 19, House Bill 350, now before you, relates to exemption from jury service fire marshals. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:58:39] Ayes 97, noes 1. Ayes 97, noes 1. The bill passes. House Bill 382 is legislation relating to school board chairman and vice chairman, additional annual salary amount. Shall the bill pass?

[00:59:03] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 71, noes 27. Ayes 71, noes 27. The bill passes. House Bill 383, now before you, relates to the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia, exemption of certain courses and programs of instruction from certification requirement.

[00:59:20] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 95, noes 3. Ayes 95, noes 3. The bill passes. Over on page 20, bill before you next is House Bill 397, relating to clean energy and community flood preparedness market-based trading program.

[00:59:44] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 63, noes 35. Ayes 63, noes 35.

[01:00:00] The bill passes. House Bill 416 relates to use of school buses for public purposes by local governing bodies, insurance reimbursement. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:00:20] Ayes 66, noes 31. Ayes 66, noes 31. The bill passes. House Bill 427 relates to State Council of Higher Education, Virginia or Shev, uniform comprehensive data information system information on self-identified students who are parents shall the bill pass clerk will close the row eyes 97 no zero eyes 97 no zero the bill passes house bill 449 relates to civil actions filed on behalf of multiple persons class actions

[01:00:57] violation of virginia consumer protection act award of damages shall the bill pass clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, noes 34. Ayes 64, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 521 relates to the Marine Resources Commission Powers and Duties Wetlands. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close

[01:01:36] the roll. Ayes 74, noes 24. Ayes 74, noes 24. The bill passes. House Bill 786 is not before you over on page 22 continuing third reading final passage regular calendar. House Bill 803 before you now relates to repairs or maintenance of property, entering, adjoining property, petition for entry. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 69, noes 29. Ayes 69, noes 29. The bill

[01:02:15] passes. That's bill 859 relates to the Department of Education Farm to School Program Task Force Membership Requirements Report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 2.

[01:02:34] Ayes 93, noes 2. The bill passes. That's bill 640. Now before he relates to elections, challenges to voter or voters' registration. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the rope.

[01:02:54] Ayes, 63, no's 35. Ayes, 63, no's 35. The bill passes. Top of page 23, House Bill 773, relates to elections, absentee voting, a cure process. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the rope. Ayes, 62, no's 35. Ayes, 62, no's 35. The bill passes. House Bill 968 is now before you.

[01:03:32] relates to election results counting machine readable ballots. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 65, nos 33. Ayes 65, nos 33. The bill passes. House Bill 1014 relates to incapacitated persons finding a lack of capacity to understand act of voting. Shall the bill pass?

[01:04:03] Clerk will close the vote. Ayes 64, nos 34. Ayes 64, nos 34. The bill passes. Over on page 24 we continue house bill 1321 relates to elections conduct of primaries abstracts of votes law enforcement officer uh to obtain returns not forwarded shall the bill pass clerk will close

[01:04:43] the roll ayes 89 nos 8 ayes 89 nos 8 the bill passes us bill 1348 relates to campaign finance large pre-election contributions report election day reporting requirement shall the bill pass Clerk will close the roll.

[01:05:08] Ayes 80, noes 15. Ayes 80, noes 15. The bill passes. House Bill 123 relates to delinquent children, loss of driving privileges for alcohol, firearm, and drug offenses, truancy. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:05:33] Ayes 91, noes 6. Ayes 91, noes 6. The bill passes. House Bill 131 relates to public institutions of higher education, reasonable accommodations for religious beliefs, and practices of individual students. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 94. Noes, 2. Ayes, 94. Noes, 2. The bill passes.

[01:06:02] House Bill 149 relates to a decrease in probation period. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 87. Noes, 11. Ayes, 87. Noes, 11. The bill passes. House Bill 854 relating to real property tax, local classification, or designation for portion of property. Shall the bill pass?

[01:06:31] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 97, noes 0. Ayes 97, noes 0. The bill passes. Over on page 26, we come to House Bill 118, which relates to discovery methods of delivery.

[01:06:53] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, excuse me, ayes 96, noes 2. Ayes 96, noes 2. The bill passes.

[01:07:09] House Bill 474 relates to real estate with delinquent taxes or liens. Appointment of special commissioner increases required value. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:07:28] Ayes, 97, no, 0. Ayes, 97, no, 0. The bill passes. House Bill 113 relates to elections, offenses, soliciting or accepting bribe to influence or procure a voter registration penalty.

[01:07:45] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 95, no, 3.

[01:08:00] Ayes, 95, no, 3. The bill passes. We have seven more to pick back up elsewhere earlier in the calendar. We're turning to page four, House Bill 185 relates to orders closing a proceeding or sealing a record, petitions for review.

[01:08:16] Shall the bill pass?

[01:08:29] Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 98. No, zero. Turning to page seven, we pick back up House Bill 326, authorized in the Commonwealth to convey Fort Whitworth to the Petersburg Battlefields Foundation.

[01:08:53] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[01:09:12] Ayes, 96. Nose 2. Eyes 96. Nose 2. The bill passes. Over on page 8, we do now before you is House Bill 363 relating to the Commonwealth of Virginia Innovation Partnership Act, Regional Innovation Fund, Commonwealth Commercialization Fund, matching funds.

[01:09:38] Shall the bill pass?

[01:09:48] Clerk will close the roll. Eyes 93. Nose 4. Eyes 93. Nose 4. The bill passes. Over on page 9, we come to House Bill 510 relating to Uniform Power of Attorney Act, agent's duty of disclosure.

[01:10:16] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:10:32] Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero. The bill passes. Over on page 10, we come to House Bill 528, which relates to a compromise of claim for death by wrongful act, approval without a hearing.

[01:10:50] Shall the bill pass?

[01:10:59] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 98, no zero. Ayes 98, no zero. the bill passes. He already got his kudos. He already got his kudos. It's one time. I don't know what kind of sex flash y'all took. You can't be a virgin, but once. Last two, Mr. Speaker, over on page 12 in this category, a third reading regular House Bill 78. It relates to elections, administration, duties of local electoral boards, certification of election, grounds for removal,

[01:11:33] civil penalty. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 91, excuse me, Ayes 92, Ayes 92, noes 6, the bill passes.

[01:11:55] And lastly, House Bill 1244 relates to elections, absentee voting, emergency application for absentee ballot. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:12:17] Ayes 92, noes 5. Ayes 92, noes 5, the bill passes. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we continue the calendar. Next category, new category, House bills on second reading, uncontested calendar. The uncontested calendar block begins on page 27, has about 30 odd bills in it, beginning with House Bill 57, which seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to fees for vehicles designed and used for transportation of passengers, funds returned to a locality, permitted uses. The Legislation Report Committee on Transportation.

[01:12:50] Delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Fagans. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 57 updates the 4 for Life program by allowing localities to use their existing share of EMS funds to not only for training and equipment... Would you like to move the committee amendment? Yes, I would, Mr. Speaker.

[01:13:06] Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. Oh, I'm looking at the round one. Keep it moving. You were right. You were right this one time. Keep talking about your bill. Again, with House Bill 57, also for maintenance and essential operating costs for approved nonprofit and volunteer squads, this bill does not raise fees to change the funding formula and improves reliability and response times.

[01:13:29] I ask that the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. Madam Speaker, continuing with today's uncontested second reading calendar, we come next to a Delegate Bennett Parker's House Bill 94, legislation seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to vehicle registration fees, disabled veterans.

[01:13:50] Legislation Report Committee on Transportation with amendments. The Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Bennett Parker. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. the amendment is agreed to delegate bennett parker thank you madam speaker house bill 94 would allow veterans who are permanently and totally disabled as certified by the u.s department of veterans affairs

are blind or have lost the use of a hand or limb who are already eligible for a free license plate and to have their annual registration fee waived the option of receiving a free standard license plate rather than only one that labels them as a disabled veteran the bill was brought to me by a constituent who prefers to not be publicly identified as a

[01:14:28] disabled veteran because it brings up questions and memories he'd rather not think about i move the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Next up in the block, turning to page 28, if you're following around that way, is House Bill 141. It seeks to amend and reenact several sections of the Code of Virginia, all related to Virginia Passenger Rail Authority exemptions. Legislation report committee on transportation with an amendment. The delegate from Loudoun, Delegate Reed. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendment.

[01:14:53] Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, vote aye. All those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 141 updates It's the Virginia Passion of Rail Authority to include additional exemptions and to better align it with the same exemptions that currently apply to the Virginia Department of Transportation.

[01:15:12] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading. Next up in the block, House Bill 184 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia, land a health carrier contract, site neutral payment policy for applicable services, annual report, civil penalty. Legislation report, committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute.

[01:15:29] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Homer. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The substitutes agree to. Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 184 directs the Bureau of Insurance of the State Corporation Commission to conduct a comprehensive report on Virginia's all-payer claims database, report back to the Governor and General Assembly by December 1st, 2026.

[01:15:53] I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Top of page 29, we come to House Bill 218. Legislative seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to casino gaming, consideration of service permit applications, legislation reporting committee on general laws.

[01:16:09] The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate McQuinn. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Today's Virginia gaming and hospitality industry supports thousands of jobs and generate billions in economic activity across the Commonwealth, yet too many qualified Virginians, especially those challenged or undeserved population, face unnecessary delays or barrier to employment due to outdated process.

[01:16:31] So House Bill 218 does three things. First, it established a 30-business day timeline for permit decisions, giving both workers and employers certainty and efficiency. Secondly, it allows applicants to provide a written narrative and character reference, ensuring individuals are evaluated as a whole person and not just paperwork.

[01:16:52] And third, it focused the background review on reasonable and recent time frame by fully protecting the integrity of the gaming operation. House Bill 218 reflects Virginia values, accountability, opportunity, and common sense. I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading.

[01:17:10] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Continuing with the block, House Bill 304. Now before you, seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the assumption of a mortgage or deed of trust. Conventional home mortgage loans required to include assumption provisions. Legislation Board committing on labor and commerce with amendments.

[01:17:26] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Madam Speaker, I move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 304 requires any lender for a conventional home mortgage in Virginia on residential real estate located in Virginia to include provisions in the loan allowing any existing borrower to assume the mortgage in a divorce if the assuming borrower qualifies under the lender's loan criteria.

[01:17:56] This bill will help divorcing couples who are struggling with trying to keep the family home with one of the spouses, and particularly if they have children who they don't want to have displaced. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Turning to page 30, continue with the uncontested second reading, calendar block, House Bill 316.

[01:18:14] Now before you, seeks to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia all relating to the Virginia Stock Corporation Act, Legislation Reporting Committee on Labor and Commerce with an amendment of nature of substitute. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:18:31] This institute is agreed to. Delegate Hope. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, members of the body, this monumental bill makes technical amendments to the Stock Corporation Act, including amendments to reflect changes to the ABA's Model Business Corporation Act and the Delaware General Corporation Law. I hope it would be a pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third read.

[01:18:49] House Bill 323, now before you, seeks to direct the Department of Energy to make certain findings and recommendations and to convene a work group to provide expertise and feedback on the use of waste heat from data centers. Report legislation for the Committee on Labor and Commerce again with the amendment nature substitute.

[01:19:07] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitutes agree to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, the impacts of data centers on our grid and localities is an enormous issue.

[01:19:26] HB 323 creates an opportunity to create positive impacts from data centers. Data centers produce enormous amounts of heat, and that heat can be captured and used to heat nearby manufacturing facilities or even nearby schools and homes. It also reduces the load a data center puts on our grid by as much as 30%.

[01:19:43] This is being done all over the world, but not here in Virginia. Madam Speaker, HB 323 tasks the Department of Energy with leading an effort to accelerate our use of waste heat and make Virginia a leader in this technology. I hope it'll be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:20:00] Next up in the block, different bills, same patron, House Bill 327. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sections code of Virginia related to the Commonwealth Health Reinsurance Program, extension of program, percentage goal to decrease premiums. Legislation again report Committee on Labor and Commerce this time with amendments.

[01:20:17] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendment. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendment, I'm sorry, is agreed to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. This bill is a recommendation of the Health Insurance Reform Commission.

[01:20:34] The SEC's Bureau of Insurance administers the Commonwealth Health Reinsurance Program, which is funded by a mix of federal pass-through funding and state money in the CHIRP Special Fund. It's approved by CMS for five years. The current program expiration date is December 31, 2027.

[01:20:50] H.B. 327 directs the SEC to apply for a five-year extension of CHIRP from CMS, and the SEC must file no later than December 31, 2026. This bill, as I said, is a recommendation of HIRC, and I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:21:07] House Bill 330 is legislation to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to signs and advertisements adjacent to certain highways, Signs affixed to real property owned by the Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority or WMATA. Legislation report committee on transportation with amendment nature substitute.

[01:21:24] The delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate McClure. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, in the substitute HB 330 would provide the Washington Metropolitan Area Transit Authority the opportunity to begin engaging with federal, state, and local authorities to pursue authorization to place advertisements on WMATA-owned facilities in the Commonwealth.

[01:21:54] Currently, advertising is permitted throughout the metro system in Washington, D.C. However, advertising is not currently permitted in Virginia on metro assets, such as parking garages. Given the critical importance of funding public transportation, I appreciate WMATA's efforts to identify new internal sources of revenue to continue delivering reliable public transportation.

[01:22:12] Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 346, Legislative Amendment and Reenact, Section of the Code of Virginia, relating to the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, exclusions to application of chapter public utility account numbers, Legislative Report Committee on General Laws.

[01:22:30] The delegate from Rockbridge, Delegate McLaughlin. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 346 is a FOIA bill that allows the exclusion of public utility account numbers from the information that is required under the Freedom of Information Act. Madam Speaker, I ask that we engross the bill and move it to its third reading.

[01:22:47] Over on page 32, we continue second reading on contested calendar block. House Bill 353, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia related to Benefit Consortium Sponsoring Association. Legislation report will be on Labor and Commerce. The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Coulson. Thank you, Madam Speaker.

[01:23:03] House Bill 353 allows 501c3 nonprofits to serve as a sponsoring association for a benefits consortium, i.e. group insurance. It's a privilege already afforded to 501c5s and 501c6s, and its passage would allow thousands of nonprofit employees to access affordable group health plans.

[01:23:21] I ask that it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. House Bill 395 seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia relating to electric utilities, small portable solar generation devices. Legislation for the Committee on Labor and Commerce with the amendment of Nature Substitute.

[01:23:39] delegate from fairfax sorry hold on the delegate from fairfax delegate kruzik thank you madam speaker members of the body i move the committee substitute shall the substitute be agreed to all in favor say aye aye all opposed no all right substitutes agree to thank you madam speaker this bill would allow virginians to install what is commonly referred to as balcony solar panels this bill allows for individuals to install small portable solar panels to their balcony or backyard these would have been really good during this storm

[01:24:15] because the ice would just slide off it, plus the ice on the ground, you'd get that solar effect rebounding back on them. So I would hope that it's the will of the body to engross and pass this on to its third reading. Continuing with the block, House Bill 424 seeks to amend and reenact, excuse me, seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to health insurance, prohibited restrictions on in-network referrals.

[01:24:41] Legislation report committing on labor and commerce with an amendment in the nature of substitute. The delegate from Henrico, Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I'd like to move adoption of Labor and Commerce Substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:24:57] The substitutes agree to. Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 424 protects patients from harmful insurance steering practices that can delay diagnosis and disrupt care, even when their doctors and labs are already in network. We've seen cases where insurers override forced tests out of network and delayed critical diagnosis, leading to avoidable medical emergencies.

[01:25:19] And with that, Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading. New bill, new page, same patron. House Bill 437 now before you. Seeks to amend and reenact. Sections code of Virginia related to insurance, standards of conduct for licensed public adjusters, unauthorized practice of public adjusting.

[01:25:35] Legislative reporting committee on labor and commerce with amendments. The delegate from Enrico, Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I'd like to move adoption of the amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:25:50] The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate LeVere Bowling. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 437 strengthens consumer protections by cracking down on unlicensed public adjusting and updating standards of conduct for licensed public adjusters. It gives regulators clearer enforcement tools, adds safeguards for vulnerable adults, and improves transparency in advertising and solicitation practices.

[01:26:12] This legislation protects homeowners at their most vulnerable moments and helps stop bad actors before more harm is done. And with that, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed its third reading. Over on page 34, we come to House Bill 439, a bill to amend and reenact a wide variety of sections of code, repeal several others, all relating to the Virginia Non-Stock Corporation Act.

[01:26:31] Legislation is reporting on labor and commerce with a lengthy amendment in nature substitute. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Hope. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no.

[01:26:48] Substitute's agreed to. Delegate Hope. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I just read about five minutes ago an update to the Virginia Stock Corporation Act. However, this bill is an update to the Virginia Non-Stock Corporation Act.

[01:27:03] Most of the changes are technical and they conform to provisions currently in the Virginia Stock Corporation Act. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third read. House Bill 446 at the bottom of page 34 is out of the block over to the regular calendar. Therefore, continuing second reading on contested counter block is House Bill 479.

[01:27:22] This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Securities Act, Investment Advisor Advertising. Legislation was reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Helmer. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, House Bill 479 simply aligns advertising standards for investment advisors with federal standards.

[01:27:42] Hope it is well the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third bill. House Bill 481 at the bottom of page 35 is out of the block over to the regular calendar. Therefore, coming to page 36, we come to Delegate Watts' House Bill 498. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact several sections of the Code of Virginia relating to motor carrier violations, authority of law enforcement officers, legislation reporting on transportation.

[01:28:02] The Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Madam Speaker. This bill would allow law enforcement officers to issue the authorized civil penalties for commercial motor vehicle license, registration tax requirements, or vehicle size limitation violations anywhere within their jurisdiction.

[01:28:21] Currently, they can only issue summons for traffic violations. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill. Pass it to its third reading. House Bill 559 seeks to amend and reenact section of the Code of Virginia related to driver training school and driver training instructors standards discipline report legislation reported on the committee on transportation the delegate from hanover delegate wyatt thank you madam speaker house bill 559 prohibits the employment of a driver training school instructor to teach driver education courses if the instructor has been convicted of certain sex crimes or offenses i hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and

[01:28:58] pass it on to its third reading house bill 570 as legislation seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to motor vehicle dealers, dealer records, and advertisements. Legislation report committee on transportation. The delegate from Virginia Beach, Delegate Figgins. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 570 makes two small updates to Virginia motor vehicle dealer laws. It modernizes record keeping by allowing approved electronic storage while maintaining existing retention and location requirements. It also strengthens advertising transparency by requiring advertisements, ads that do not have the name of the dealer to include

[01:29:35] VADLR, clearly identifying licensed Virginia dealers. Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass to its third reading. Over on page 37, we come to House Bill 586, legislation to amend and reenact, Section Code of Virginia, relating to motor vehicle dealers again.

[01:29:51] This time, conduct of business, business hours, filing changes, Legislation Board Committee on Transportation. The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 586 is simple technical fix to the code that states that the motor vehicle dealers change their business hours they must report those hours to the motor vehicle dealer board rather than the DMV. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to the third its third reading. New bill same patron house bill 608 before you in the block seeks to amend and reenact section of the code relating to dealers license plates permitted uses legislation on transportation with amendments. The delegate from Hanover

[01:30:29] Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 608 authorizes the use of dealer tags or dealer license plates on vehicles delivering or transporting vehicle parts and accessories and fuel. As long as such delivery or transport of the fuel consists of no more than five gallons in an improved container.

[01:31:03] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Over on page 38, we come to House Bill 628, Legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia related to electric utilities, renewable energy portfolios, standard program requirements, power purchase agreements, Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce with amendments.

[01:31:23] The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendments. The questions on the committee amendments, shall they be agreed to? All in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. Committee amendments are agreed to. Delegate Coulson.

[01:31:38] House Bill 628 improves upon a bill that was passed unanimously out of this body last session. In direct or short terms, it puts more solar in places that we all agree it can go. Hitting the really high points, it raises a carve-out for distributed solar. It expands how much of that solar is placed on previously developed sites.

[01:31:56] It allows power purchase agreements for all Virginians, and it has additional protections for ratepayers. I ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 644. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia, a related to the Virginia Freedom of Information Act, exemption for records of minors participating in certain programs run by state public bodies.

[01:32:17] Legislation report committee on general laws. The delegate from Richmond County, Delegate Kent. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 644 is a bill that exempts a minor's contact information when that minor participates in a state internship or apprenticeship program.

[01:32:33] This bill was worked on and approved by the FOIA Council. And, Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Next up in the uncontested second reading block is House Bill 788, which seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to vehicle crash reports open to inspection by certain persons, towing, and recovery operators.

[01:32:50] Legislation report video on transportation with amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Bonitide, Delegate Austin. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, I move the substitute. Committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Austin.

[01:33:05] Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB 788 allows public safety tow and recovery operators timely access to police accident report when called by law enforcement to clear crashes and restore traffic flow. I've asked that the bill be engrossed to move to its third reading.

[01:33:21] House Bill 807 seeks to amend and reenact a portion of the Code of Virginia-related electric utilities, shared solar programs, Phase II utility. Legislative reporting committee on Labor and Commerce with amendment 8. Substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan.

[01:33:39] Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB 807 expands the Dominion Shared Solar Program with Dominion authorized to release an additional 525 megawatts of capacity by July 1, 2026.

[01:33:59] The bill directs Dominion to petition the Commission to initiate a proceeding to further expand shared solar as part three of the program on or before part two of such program is substantially complete. The bill directs the Commission to evaluate the costs and benefits of shared solar and to consider the results in determining any future allocations of shared solar capacity and changes in the program design.

[01:34:19] It directs the Commission to update its regulations by December 3126 and to require each participating utility to file any tariffs necessary for implementation by March 1, 2027. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Madam Speaker, new bill, new page, same patron.

[01:34:36] This one is House Bill 809, which seeks to amend and reenact the Code of Virginia relating to Electric Utilities Shared Solar Programs Phase I Utility. This legislation is reporting committee on labor and commerce, likewise with the amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker.

[01:34:51] I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 809 is a recommendation of the Commission on Electric Utility Regulation. It creates a modest expansion of the APCO shared solar program of 50 megawatts by June of 2028, with future expansion at the discretion of the SEC.

[01:35:14] It also requires a new net crediting functionality to be established, which allows participating customers to receive credits on their bill from the shared solar program and pay subscription costs directly on their bill. Finally, it requires APCO to file any tariffs. Implementing such programs by March 1, 2027, I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:35:34] Next up in the block is House Bill 828, which seeks to amend the Code of Virginia Related Electric Utilities. Disconnection reports, State Corporation Commission database, annual summary. Legislation reporting on labor and commerce with amendments.

[01:35:56] We're good. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Chair. Madam Speaker. Is there an amendment? There is. I move the amendment. There is a substitute. I move the substitute.

[01:36:12] All those in favor of the substitute, say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitute's agreed to. Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 828 requires each investor-owned utility and electric co-op operating in the Commonwealth to provide a monthly report on residential customer disconnections to the State Corporation Commission.

[01:36:34] This report is required to include specific information outlined in the bill, including the number of residential customers involuntarily disconnected due to non-payment, the amount of time in which such customers were reconnected to the service, the amount of arrearages attributable to such disconnected customers and other residential customers, and information related to how many of them participate in a payment assistance program or have a serious medical condition on form.

[01:36:57] we're talking about the speaker's bill here right now the bill requires the Commission Madam Speaker this bill is a recommendation of the Commission on Electric Utility Regulation I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading thank you continue with the block top of page 41 we come to House Bill 943 legislation amendment and reenact six Dakota Virginia relating to free use of toll facilities campus police officers this legislation report committee on transportation the delegate from montgomery

[01:37:36] delegate franklin thank you madam speaker house bill 943 authorizes campus police officers to use toll roads in the commonwealth without payment while in the performance of their official duties i hope it'll be the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading next up in the block is house bill 1045 which would allow the board of directors of the virginia alcoholic beverage control authority to issue an annual mixed beverage performing arts facility license to certain persons operating food concessions at any performing arts facility in the city of Richmond. Legislation reporting committee on general laws. The delegate from

[01:38:12] Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1045 creates a temporary and narrowly defined pathway to receiving a performing arts facility mixed beverage license. This legislation is a section one bill and does not change the existing licensure framework. I move to engross the bill and pass it to the third reading.

[01:38:37] Continuing with the block, House Bill 1237 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to cemeteries, maintenance of abandoned or neglected graveyards, owner unknown, legislation forthcoming on general laws. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Sewell. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1237 seeks to grant locality's ability to petition a circuit court for permission to maintain private cemeteries that have been neglected due to a variety of circumstances. Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and pass it to the third reading.

[01:39:05] And finally, top of page 42, last bill in the second reading uncontested counterblock is House Bill 1308, which seeks to amend and reenact Section Dakota-Virginia related to the Virginia Public Procurement Act definitions professional services. Delegate from Dinwiddie, Delegate Pope Adams.

[01:39:22] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, current law treats professions like engineering and accounting as professional services. Yet, the Virginia Department of the Treasury currently procures statewide financial advisors, investment advisors, and insurance brokers as non-professional services.

[01:39:38] HB 1308 fixes this by allowing Treasury to select vendors based on expertise, experience, and value, just as we already do for accountants and engineers. So, Mr. Speaker, I hope it is the will of the body

to engross this bill and pass to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:39:58] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, new category, page 42 of the printed calendar, if you're following that way. House bills on second reading, regular calendar. Second reading, regular, about a dozen plus bills in this category, beginning with House Bill 423. House Bill 423 seeks to amend and reenact the section of the Code of Virginia related to Roanoke, Higher Education Authority, Board of Trustees, membership.

[01:40:19] The legislation reports video on education. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Russell. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, House Bill 423 simply updates the charter language for the Roanoke Higher Ed Center. I hope it will be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:40:35] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? Are those in favor, say aye. Are those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 550 is legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia, related to admissions tax in counties, retail, sales, and use tax dedicated to promotion of tourism.

[01:40:50] Legislation was reported from the Committee on Finance. Delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 550 is a permissive bill that allows James City and York counties the ability to self-govern and determine the appropriate course of action when it comes to emissions for venues within their jurisdiction.

[01:41:08] Currently, they are the only two localities in the Commonwealth that cannot make these local decisions, and we are hindering them from the ability to work for their constituents directly. This bill is not only bipartisan in nature, but corrects the language of previous legislation that granted the other localities this right and is simply ensuring fairness across the Commonwealth.

[01:41:24] With that, Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Would the patron yield for a question? Would the patron yield? The patron will yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Hypothetically speaking, if my family and I had season passes to Busch Gardens, and those season passes cost $300 for two of us, James City County enacted this 10% tax, how much would those season passes then cost my family?

[01:41:51] The delegate from James City County, Delegate Anderson. Mr. Speaker, I would let the delegate know that that would be at the discretion of the locality, as my colleagues on the right are a huge advocate for. So I would leave that to James City to decide. Mr. Speaker, speaking of the bill.

[01:42:08] Delegates, the floor. I'm a huge advocate for affordability, and I just think this is a 10% tax on everybody that wants to take their kids to Busch Gardens. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:42:24] Over on page 43, we come to House Bill 1171, directing the Board of Education to develop, approve, and implement alternative graduation pathways to earn a standard diploma report. The Legislature was reported to the Committee on Education with amendments. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, the bill's patron has a floor substitute.

[01:42:43] Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, I would move the committee amendments and ask the House to vote no. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. No.

[01:42:59] The committee amendment is not agreed to. Delegate from Roanoke, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Now there is a floor substitute. The floor substitute, which I'll ask you to adopt in just a moment, reflects some input from the administration and some from other stakeholders who have come together and said that this should be a good path in moving forward. This is to develop additional graduation pathways for students who may be struggling with certain standardized tests. So, Mr. Speaker, I would ask that the House adopt the floor substitute. Shall the floor substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:43:38] Now I would ask that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 422, as legislation to amend and reenact, Section of the Code of Virginia relating to public utilities prohibition of multiple rate increases within three-year period for certain utilities.

[01:44:01] Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with an amendment in nature of substitute. The delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye.

[01:44:16] All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 422 addresses affordability, transparency, and stability. It provides for a triennial rate case limitation that would provide counties and the SEC more time with set predictable rates before they are once again submitted for adjustment and hold regulated water monopolies accountable for better operational and fiscal planning and management.

[01:44:41] The bill was brought to me by the locality and constituents asking for relief. With that, Mr. Speaker, I move it is the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. The delegate from Fredericksburg, Delegate Cole. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:44:56] Will the gentlewoman yield for a question? I yield. Will the delegate from Fredericksburg, I mean the delegate from Spotsylvania, yield for a question? Mr. Speaker, I'll yield. She will yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Looking at the bill, the bill states that it should meet either the Safe Drinking Water Act or the Clean Water Act.

[01:45:13] I would ask the gentleman woman, what does she think Virginians deserve more, safe water or clean water? I believe that. Mr. Speaker. Oh, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the question, I would say that I believe that Virginians deserve both safe and clean water.

[01:45:41] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Any more softball questions? The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, will the delegate yield for a question? Will the delegate yield? Will the delegate yield? The delegate will yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the delegate, I'm looking at the calendar and I'm looking at the list of patrons to this bill, and I appreciate the desire to get bipartisan support, but does the delegate know that she doesn't have to accept every co-patron request that comes across her desk?

[01:46:08] Mr. Speaker, I do understand that. All right. And, Mr. Speaker, one additional question. Will the delegate yield for one additional question? The delegate yield. The delegate will yield, Mr. Speaker. We are going to ask the delegate if she knows it's not too late to remove a patron, go patron, from your bill.

[01:46:24] Mr. Speaker, I do understand that. I thank the delegate. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Hallelujah. Turning to page 44, we come to House Bill 450.

[01:46:44] Legislation to amend and reenact Section of Dakota, Virginia related to Office of Vital Records. Fees for certified copies. Legislation reported on health and human services with an amendment. Delegate from Hinton-Ryco. Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the House to adopt the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:47:00] The committee amendment is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, HB450 increases the fees for a certified copy of a vital record from $12 to no more than $17. This fee has not been increased in the Commonwealth for more than 20 years. This is a self-funded agency, and they need this fee to be able to keep staffing the agency and providing vital records to Virginians.

[01:47:18] I hope it may be the will of the Spidey to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Would the patron yield for a question? Would the patron yield for a question? I yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. If I understand this correctly, this is a 40% roughly increase when you go after a family member dies to get a death certificate or if you want your driver's record. Is that correct, Mr. Speaker?

[01:47:38] Mr. Speaker, speaking of the question, this just affects vital records, not a driving record. DMV is one of the entities that provides vital records to citizens in Virginia. Mr. Speaker, is this not a 40% increase in the fee for those records? Mr. Speaker, speaking to the question, this is an increase, and as I emphasized, the first time this has been increased in 20 years.

[01:48:01] This is a self-funded agency, and we have two choices. We can increase the fee, or we can make it a general fund agency, and I think the former is a better option. It's integral to the processes of business and families to be able to get these records, and we need to keep this agency staffed and functioning. Thank you.

[01:48:17] Thank you, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor. I'm just curious how this helps affordability. The delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams.

[01:48:36] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, question for the patron. Would the delegate yield for a question? I'll yield for one more. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I was just curious if the patron thought this was a small fee increase. Does the patron want to respond?

[01:48:55] Mr. Speaker, respond to the question. This has been an increase that's been postponed not once, not twice, but for over 20 years. And it may have been a small increase if they had had incremental increases over the last 20 years. They were not able to do that. This agency could only increase their fee by our direction.

[01:49:11] They've waited as long as they can. They're against the wall. They need to make this increase now. We need to keep this agency solvent. Thank you. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 466 now before you.

[01:49:27] Sixth Amendment Act. Section of the Code of Virginia relating to the State Corporation Commission time frame for completion of certain proceedings. Legislation report committing on labor and commerce with amendments. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Cohen. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, I'd ask that the body adopt the amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to?

[01:49:42] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 466 will require that within nine months, the State Corporation Commission must complete application proceedings for certificates, permits, or approvals that are required for the construction or operation by a public utility of a small renewable energy project or certain transmission lines.

[01:50:05] The commission is granted with good cause proven a one-time extension of up to 120 days after the original nine months have passed. This would not require the SEC to approve projects.

[01:50:20] It simply requires them to accept or reject an application. I ask the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is in gross past the third reading. Page 45, we come to House Bill 633.

[01:50:36] It seeks to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia all related to the Commission on Electric, Utility, Regulation, Scope, and Name Change. Legislature reported from the Committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment and Nature Substitute. The Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, ladies and gentlemen of the House, I would move that we adopt the committee substitute.

[01:50:53] Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, now with the adoption of the substitute, all this bill does is change the sewer committee's name to the Energy Commission of Virginia. I hope it would be the pleasure of the House to engross the bill.

[01:51:12] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 649, the bottom page 45, is by for the day. Therefore, next up, second reading regular, top of page 46, is House Bill 791, Legislation to amend and reenact various sections of the Code of Virginia, all related to charitable gaming, conduct of athletic event drawings.

[01:51:35] This legislation is for the Committee on General Laws. That's from Bonatak, Delegate Austin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 791 modernizes Virginia's existing 50-50 charitable raffles by allowing electronic drawings and electronic games at a large-scale sporting event. The bill eliminates duplicate ticket printing, reduces fraud risk, improves transparency, and lowers administrative costs.

[01:51:55] The report of General Laws 20-1, and I'd ask the bill being engrossed to move to third read. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1052, now before you, seeks to amend and

reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Board of Pharmacy Membership Registered Pharmacy Technician, Legislation Report Committee on Health and Human Services.

[01:52:18] Delegate from Heron County, Delegate Phillips. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1052 simply adds one member to the Board of Pharmacy, and that would be a registered pharmacy technician. And I hope it will be of the will of the body to engross this bill and move it to its third reading. Thank you. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? Now, those in favor, say aye.

[01:52:35] Those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Continuing, page 46. House Bill 1161 seeks to amend and reenact several sections of the Code of Virginia related to the Government Data Collection and Dissemination Practices Act, dissemination of personal information to the federal government, civil penalties, the Legislation Report Committee on General Laws, And Mr. Speaker, Delegate Williams has two floor amendments that are available online and in IHUD for the members here.

[01:53:07] I will let her explain the bill first. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Mr. Speaker, to explain the bill, House Bill 1161 sets clear guardrails on when state and local governments may share Virginians' personal information.

[01:53:28] It allows data to be released only when required by law, necessary to administer authorized programs, ordered by a court or subpoena, required by contract, or with an individual's consent. It also modernizes what counts as protected personal data and adds accountability for willful misuse.

[01:53:46] The Delegate, you want to move that it be engrossed? I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate of Williams. Yes, Mr. Speaker. I would move the amendment. Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Fairfax.

[01:54:02] Can this bill go by temporarily so we get a chance to take a look at these amendments? I'm not sure. I may or may not have questions about their germaneness or their applicability. I just, I don't know if we could just take this bill by temporarily. Without objection, HB 1161 goes by temporarily. It'll drop.

[01:54:26] Next up is House Bill 606. House Bill 606 is legislation to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to medical care, facility, data reporting, value of charity care. This Legislation Report Committee on Health and Human Services and the bill's patron has a floor substitute, which is available to the members.

[01:54:47] That's from M. Reicho, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the floor substitute. And speaking to that substitute, this is just making technical changes to make the code sites consistent throughout the bill, Mr. Speaker. Shall the floor substitute be agreed to?

[01:55:03] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Floor substitute is agreed to. And, Mr. Speaker, briefly speaking to the bill, this bill simply streamlines the annual charity care reporting process for medical facilities. I hope it will abide to engross this bill and pass it to its third reading. Should the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading?

[01:55:19] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. All right, Mr. Speaker, going back in several pages, if you follow along that way, page 34, House Bill 446 is now before you. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia

relating to the Virginia Passenger Rail Authority, eminent domain, Legislative Report Committee on Transportation with amendments.

[01:55:45] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, what this bill does is it lines up the Virginia Passenger Rail Authority's, eminent domain authority with that of the Virginia Department of Transportation.

[01:56:02] We set up the Virginia Passenger Rail Authority back in 2020 with enabling legislation. These are just sort of technical tweaks to go back and make sure that they have the eminent domain authority they need to get their projects done quickly and efficiently and as efficiently as possible. Help us to build the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading.

[01:56:20] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. And then over on page 35 comes Delegate Hope's House Bill 481, which seeks to amend and reenact Several sections of the Code of Virginia are related to prior authorization requiring physician review for denial.

[01:56:39] Legislation support committee on labor and commerce with an amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Arlington. Delegate Hope. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 481 is related to prior authorization. It seeks to ensure that medical decisions are made by medical professionals and that no carrier can issue an adverse determination for either drugs or services without a license, physicians, or a pharmacist approval.

[01:57:05] It will be a pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, we come back to pick up House Bill 1161, legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to Virginia Data Collections Dissemination Practice Act, dissemination of personal information to federal government, civil penalties, legislation reported from general laws, and then the floor amendments were taken by temporarily or now backed before you by Delegate Williams.

[01:57:39] Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Mr. Speaker? The Delegate from Fairfax. Mr. Speaker, I move that we pass by the floor amendment? Two. The Delegate from Fairfax moves that we pass by the floor amendments. You'll have two minutes to speak on that.

[01:57:57] I will start my timer now. call on a delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I bring this amendment and I rise here today to speak to it and tell you guys why I support it. Why? I am encouraged to see my colleagues across the aisle embracing the principle that Virginia should not simply hand over sensitive personal information to the federal authorities without clear legal obligation to do so, putting guardrails around it. As a proud son of the rebellious, moonshining

[01:58:31] region of the Commonwealth, sticking it to the Fed is a principal I too share. The bill before us says we will not turn over personal information except for narrowly tailored reasons. I agree. My amendment simply extends that same protection to another category of personal information, firearm ownership. Virginia has long recognized that firearms records deserve protection. We destroy our instant

background check records, and we don't maintain a state registry of gun owners. We don't do this at the federal level either. That's not an accident. It reflects a

[01:59:07] considered judgment that law-abiding citizens shouldn't have their exercise of a constitutional right catalogued by the government. But we do maintain concealed handgun permit records, and under current law, there's ambiguity about whether those records or other firearms-related information could be shared with the federal authorities for purposes that have nothing to do with law enforcement. So my amendment would make clear that Virginia agencies cannot disseminate firearm information, ownership, acquisition, or permit information to help, say, compile a federal

[01:59:42] list or registry, unless state or federal law specifically requires it. If we're going to protect Virginians from having their personal information used by the Fed, we should protect all virginians including the millions who lawfully own firearms i would ask my colleagues to consider this amendment on the merits thank you mr speaker this year i would i would simply uh ask the body to that we uh pass this by uh it should be a yes vote on the motion to pass by and i suggest that

[02:00:15] the uh delegate get his own bill no problem shall the floor amendments be agreed to all those in favor say aye. I'm sorry. Shall the floor amendments be passed by? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed no. The floor agreements. Ayes and nays. Let's go on the board. I like this math. Clerk will

[02:00:43] open the roll. Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 34. Ayes 62, noes 34. The floor amendments are passed by. Right. Miss Speaker, we continue with that wraps up House Bill Second Reading regulars. So therefore, the final category in today's calendar is our, excuse me, is

[02:01:20] resolutions uncontested calendar. Delegate McQuinn's House Short Resolution 18, page 47, HJR 18 relates to a portrait of the Honorable Yvonne Von Miller. This legislation is reported unanimously by the Committee on Rules. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate McQuinn.

[02:01:39] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, H.J.R. 18 reflects on the life of an individual that some of us may know, many of us know, and some may not. And so I want to just familiarize us with this remarkable individual and what we're doing and why.

[02:02:01] Senator Marsh, Senator Miller became in 1983 the first African-American woman elected to the Virginia House of Delegates, breaking both racial and gender barriers in the oldest continuous legislative body in the Western Hemisphere.

[02:02:21] In 1987, she went on to become the first African-American woman elected to the Virginia Senate, where she served with distinction until her passing in 2012. At the time of her death, she was the longest-serving woman in the Virginia Senate, ranking fourth in overall seniority.

[02:02:38] Throughout her tenure, Senator Miller demonstrated exceptional legislative leadership and unwavering advocacy. She helped influential committee assignments, including service on the Budget Writing Finance Committee, and notable became the first woman and the first African-American woman to chair a Virginia Senate committee, leading the Senate Transportation Committee.

[02:02:59] She was widely known for her passionate advocacy on behalf of children, the economically disadvantaged, minorities, and underserved communities. Her colleagues often refer to her as the conscious of the caucus.

[02:03:15] Her policy works span critical issues such as education funding and reform, voting rights, and protection for vulnerable population across the Commonwealth. Senator Miller's legacy has stent far beyond her legislative accomplishment. She was a mentor, a role model, inspiration to generations of women and people of color in public service, encouraging broader participation in the democratic process.

[02:03:41] Following her passing on July the 3rd, 2012, her impact continued through scholarships, honors, and statewide recognition, including being named one of Virginia's African-American trailblazers. So it is fitting, Mr. Chair, Mr. Speaker, and necessary that we honor Senator Yvonne Miller through HJRA, her 18, her courage, leadership, and lifelong commitment to justice left an indelible mark on Virginia.

[02:04:08] Her legacy continues to guide us today. So I hope it be the will of the body to move passage on H.J.R. 18 in honor of the Honorable Senator Yvonne B. Miller, where a portrait would be hung here in her honor.

[02:04:24] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Watts. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, members of the body. I would only add one word to that eloquent tribute to Senator Yvonne Miller. Speaking to the resolution. I'm speaking to the motion.

[02:04:40] Thank you. Thank you. And my word is that she was not just an inspiration and a mentor to people of color. She was a mentor to everyone that she felt needed to have her guidance and counsel and candor in addressing the issues.

[02:04:59] And she was a giant. Thank you. Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:05:19] Ayes 97, no zero. Ayes 97, no zero. The resolution is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, with that, that completes today's calendar. Per House Rule 51, the House has returned to the morning hour. Does the clerk have any additional announcements or communications? No communications, just simply the meeting schedule that's available on the General Assembly website.

[02:05:38] The meetings for this afternoon and tomorrow morning are as follows. The Committee on General Laws is meeting a half hour after adjournment, approximately 2.20, 2.30ish. They will be in House Committee Room B on the second floor once the full committee is finished.

[02:05:54] Then its ABC Gaming subcommittee will meet immediately upon adjournment of that. And then second after that subcommittee, their Procurement Open Government subcommittee will meet. So second floor, House Room B, General Laws, two of its subs. Half hour after adjournment of the House on House Room A in the lower level of the Committee on Labor and Commerce will meet.

[02:06:12] Once the full committee is finished, then its subcommittee number one will meet, work its docket. And then once that is finished, that subcommittee is finished, then subcommittee number three will meet. So, Labor and Commerce, two of its subs in House Committee Room A this afternoon.

[02:06:29] Then, skipping ahead to 4 o'clock, we come to the Committee on Education's K-12 subcommittee. So, they'll be meeting at 4 in the House Committee Room C on the second level. The last meeting, which I'm aware, is House Committee on Finances subcommittee number 2.

[02:06:45] They'll be at 4.30 in the North subcommittee room. We're good. So, that is the last subcommittee meeting. legislative meeting for today. Looking ahead to tomorrow, February 4th, Wednesday, hump day, the speaker's interfaith devotional will begin at 7 a.m. in the speaker's conference

room up on the 14th floor. P&E's voting rights subcommittee is not meeting tomorrow, so then at 7.30, ACNR's natural resources subcommittee will be meeting. I recall just speaking natural resources, natural resources subcommittee, they'll be in house committee room B, that's at 7.30.

[02:07:22] Then when they presumably finish up, or if there's a slight gap, the full committee will be meeting at 9 o'clock. So ACNR at 9 o'clock with the subcommittee before that. It's going back slightly in time. The Historically Backed Colleges and University Caucus, HBCU Caucus, is meeting at 7.30 down in the extension here in the Capitol at 7.30 tomorrow.

[02:07:44] Also at 7.30 tomorrow, the Communications, Technology, Innovations, Technology, and Innovation Subcommittee is meeting. They'll be in the House subcommittee room on the second floor over in the GAB. At 8 o'clock, the Military and Veterans Caucus will be meeting in the Senate subcommittee room on the third floor.

[02:08:04] So that's over in the GAB, of course. At 8 o'clock, Delegate Rasool's Education Committee, full committee is meeting. They'll be down in the extension, excuse me, down in the lower level, House Committee Room A.

[02:08:16] Then once the full committee's finished it's early childhood and innovation subcommittee will be meeting skipping ahead to tomorrow morning a little bit later at 10 o'clock the appropriations higher education subcommittee will be meeting up on the 12th floor appropriations room and then it'll be time for caucuses the democratic caucus at 11 15 tomorrow and the republican caucus 11 11 a.m. 11 the democrats meet 11 15 republicans at 11 a.m. Democrats in house room one Republicans in the House Room 2, Mr. Speaker, that's all the announcements I have at this time.

[02:08:51] Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Would you like to return to the first morning hour for the purpose of an introduction? Oh, sorry. I thought we were back in there. Sorry. I'd like to return. I read your mind. The delegate has the floor.

[02:09:07] Thank you so much. Colleagues, I'd like to recognize a special group joining us in the gallery today and ask them to stand. They are our fellow Virginians from the American Institute of Architects. These talented professionals don't just design the buildings that contribute to our communities.

[02:09:30] They advocate for smart, sustainable, and resilient design that shapes Virginia's future. From our schools and hospitals to our home and historic districts, architects helped us balance innovation with preservation, progress with character. They understand that good design isn't just about aesthetics.

[02:09:47] about functionality safety accessibility and sustainability many AIA Virginia members go beyond their professional practice to serve Virginia through gubernatorial appointments architects serve on critical boards and commissions including the board for architects professional engineers land surveyors certified interior designers and landscape architectures architects they serve on the art in architectural review board advising on the design of Commonwealth buildings, and they contribute to bodies like the Fair Housing Board, the State Building Code Technical Review Board, and the Secure and Resilient Commonwealth

[02:10:25] Panel, and the Virginia Board for People with Disabilities. We appreciate them being here today and their critical work across the Commonwealth. I would ask my colleagues to offer them a warm welcome, and appreciate them being here for their Hill Day.

[02:10:45] Thank you so much. Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol today. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. If we could stay in the first morning hour for an announcement.

[02:11:02] Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. On behalf of our general manager, Delegate McQuinn, we have our first basketball practice tonight at MLK Middle School at 7 p.m., where we hope to be injury-free, unless it's the Senate.

[02:11:19] Mr. Clerk. Ms. Speaker, just a clarification. Privileges and Elections Voting Rights Subcommittee is not meeting tomorrow, but the chair, normally they meet on Friday, so that subcommittee will be meeting at 7.30 on Friday before the full committee meeting.

[02:11:38] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring moves that when the House adjourns today, adjourn to reconvene tomorrow at 12 noon. As men in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. Motion is agreed to.

[02:11:53] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate for Madagascar, Delegate Heron moves that the House do not adjourn. In any favor, the motion will say aye. Opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until tomorrow at 12 noon.

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